

Psychology
Higher level and standard level
Paper 2

Specimen paper

1 hour 30 minutes

Instructions to candidates

- Do not open this examination paper until instructed to do so.
- Section A: answer all the questions.
- Section B: answer the question.
- The maximum mark for this examination paper is **[35 marks]**.

Section A

The following questions refer to your participation in a class practical. Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. Describe how you used an interview or focus group in your class practical **and** its aim and procedure. [4]
2. Explain the concept of bias in relation to the interview or focus group in your class practical. [4]
3. Compare and contrast the research methodology of an interview or focus group used in your class practical with the research methodology of an experiment. [6]
4. Design an observation to investigate the same topic you investigated in your class practical. [6]

Section B

Answer the following question.

5. Discuss the following study with reference to **two or more** of the following concepts: bias, causality, measurement, and/or responsibility. [15]

To test whether self-esteem affects attraction, Kiesler and Baral conducted an experiment. They administered a fake IQ test to two groups of men and gave them fictitious scores. One group was told that they had scored the highest scores ever seen on the test. The second group was told that there must have been some misunderstanding because
5 their scores were so low and that the test markers could not account for the errors. The second group was asked to redo the test two weeks later.

- 10 The scores were given to each participant individually, after which the participant was asked to wait in another room to receive his payment for participating in the study. During that time, an attractive woman (who was part of the experiment) walked into the room and sat one seat away from the participant. The researchers wanted to see if the participant's self-esteem affected their willingness to engage in discussion with an attractive woman. They found that the men who received high test scores engaged in conversation with the woman more quickly and in more detail than the men who received low test scores.

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References:

5. Kiesler, S. B. and Baral, R. L., 1970. "The secret for a romantic partner: The effects of self-esteem and physical attractiveness on romantic behavior." In: K. J. Gergen and D. Marlove, eds. *Personality and social behavior*. Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley. Chapter 8. SOURCE ADAPTED.